

METROPOLITAN POLICE DEPARTMENT

INCIDENT REPORT

Case Number:	MPD-2024-11-15-1847
Incident Type:	Death Investigation - Unattended
Date/Time Reported:	November 15, 2024, 14:35 hours
Date/Time of Incident:	November 13, 2024 (estimated), discovered November 15, 2024
Location:	742 Riverside Avenue, Apartment 3B
Reporting Officers:	Officer M. Martinez (#2847), Officer L. Chen (#3012)
Supervisor:	Sergeant R. Williams (#1203)
Disposition:	Referred to Medical Examiner - No Criminal Investigation

INCIDENT NARRATIVE

Initial Call and Response

On November 15, 2024, at approximately 14:35 hours, Communications Division dispatched patrol units to 742 Riverside Avenue, Apartment 3B, for a welfare check. The reporting party, identified as Ms. Patricia Henderson (DOB 03/12/1968), resident of Apartment 3A, stated that she had not seen or heard from her neighbor in approximately three days and was concerned for his welfare. Ms. Henderson reported noticing an accumulation of mail in the mailbox and an unusual odor emanating from the apartment unit.

Officer Martinez and Officer Chen arrived on scene at 14:42 hours. Upon arrival, officers made contact with Ms. Henderson in the hallway. Officers confirmed the presence of a strong decomposition odor coming from Apartment 3B. Officers knocked loudly on the door and announced their presence multiple times. No response was received. Officers attempted to contact the occupant via telephone, but calls went to voicemail.

Entry and Initial Assessment

Given the circumstances indicating a potential medical emergency or death, and after unsuccessful attempts to establish contact with the occupant, officers contacted the building landlord, Mr. Robert Kim (DOB 05/22/1975), who responded to the location with master keys. At 14:58 hours, the landlord unlocked the door. Upon opening the door, the strong odor intensified, and officers immediately

observed an apparently deceased adult male lying face-down on the living room floor.

Officers entered the apartment and approached the subject. The individual was obviously deceased with visible decomposition and lividity present. No pulse or respirations were detected. The body was cool to the touch. Due to the obvious signs of death and advanced decomposition, no resuscitation was attempted. Emergency Medical Services was notified and responded to pronounce death officially. Officers secured the scene and notified the on-call detective and Medical Examiner's office per department protocol.

Scene Description and Observations

The apartment is a one-bedroom unit measuring approximately 650 square feet. The decedent was located in the living room area, lying prone (face-down) on the floor between the sofa and coffee table. The individual was clothed in sweatpants and a t-shirt. A large pool of purge fluid and decomposition fluids had formed around the head area, staining the carpet.

The immediate area surrounding the body contained numerous empty alcoholic beverage containers. Officers documented and counted the following: seventeen (17) empty beer bottles, four (4) empty wine bottles, and three (3) empty liquor bottles (vodka and whiskey). A partially consumed bottle of vodka (approximately 1/3 full) was located on the coffee table within arm's reach of the body. Additional unopened alcoholic beverages were found in the refrigerator and kitchen cabinets.

The apartment was generally cluttered but not in disarray. No signs of struggle, forced entry, or ransacking were observed. The front door showed no evidence of forced entry, with the deadbolt and chain lock engaged from the interior. All windows were closed and locked from inside. No broken glass, damaged furniture, or other indicators of physical altercation were present.

The decedent's wallet was located on the kitchen counter and contained identification (driver's license), \$87 in cash, and credit cards. A cellular phone was located on the coffee table near the body. The phone was powered off. Personal electronics including a television and laptop computer were present and undisturbed. No suicide note or written communications suggesting intent to self-harm were discovered.

Evidence Collection and Documentation

The scene was photographed extensively by responding officers prior to any disturbance. Photographs documented the overall scene, the body position, the empty alcohol containers, points of entry/exit, and general apartment conditions. Measurements and a scene sketch were completed. No physical evidence was collected or submitted to the crime laboratory as the scene presented no indicators of criminal activity.

The decedent was identified through driver's license and subsequently confirmed through fingerprint comparison. Next of kin were notified by the Medical Examiner's office. The body was released to the Medical Examiner's office at 16:30 hours for autopsy examination.

Witness Statements

Patricia Henderson (Neighbor, Apartment 3A): Ms. Henderson stated she last saw the decedent on November 12, 2024, around 6:00 PM when she observed him returning to the building carrying grocery bags. She noted he appeared to be in his usual state of health at that time. She stated that

on previous occasions, she had observed the decedent carrying cases of beer and other alcoholic beverages into the apartment. Ms. Henderson indicated that the decedent was generally quiet and kept to himself. She was not aware of any regular visitors to the apartment. She denied hearing any arguments, disturbances, or unusual noises from the apartment in the days leading up to her report. Ms. Henderson stated she became concerned when she noticed the accumulation of mail and newspapers and detected an unusual odor.

Robert Kim (Landlord): Mr. Kim stated the decedent had been a tenant for approximately four years and had generally been a reliable tenant who paid rent on time. He described the decedent as quiet and never a source of complaints from other tenants. Mr. Kim was not aware of any recent issues or concerns regarding the decedent. He confirmed that the apartment was rented to the decedent alone with no other authorized occupants. Mr. Kim stated he had last seen the decedent approximately two weeks prior during a routine visit to the building.

Michael Torres (Neighbor, Apartment 2B): Mr. Torres, who lives in the apartment below, stated he typically heard footsteps and normal living sounds from the apartment above. He recalled hearing sounds from the apartment on the evening of November 12 but could not recall hearing anything after that date. He denied hearing any arguments, fights, or unusual disturbances. He confirmed that he had on multiple occasions observed the decedent carrying alcohol into the building.

Detective Follow-Up Investigation

Detective Sarah Morrison (#0789) from the Criminal Investigations Division responded to the scene for evaluation. After reviewing the scene, witness statements, and circumstances, Detective Morrison concurred with the initial assessment that no criminal activity was suspected. The scene was consistent with a death related to alcohol intoxication without evidence of foul play, trauma, or third-party involvement.

A background check revealed no outstanding warrants or recent police contacts involving the decedent. Employment verification confirmed the decedent had not reported to work since November 12, 2024, and his employer had been attempting to contact him. Review of cellular phone records (obtained with proper legal authority) showed the last activity was on November 13, 2024, at approximately 9:15 PM, consistent with the estimated time of death.

Medical Examiner Consultation

Dr. Sarah Thompson from the Medical Examiner's office responded to the scene and conducted an external examination of the body. Dr. Thompson observed advanced decomposition changes consistent with death occurring approximately 48-72 hours prior to discovery. No traumatic injuries were observed during the external examination. Dr. Thompson noted the large number of empty alcohol containers and the overall scene findings. The body was transported to the Medical Examiner's facility for complete autopsy examination and toxicological testing.

CONCLUSIONS AND DISPOSITION

Based on the comprehensive scene investigation, witness statements, and absence of any evidence suggesting criminal activity, this incident is classified as a death investigation with no apparent

criminal involvement. The scene findings, including the large quantity of empty alcohol containers, the absence of trauma, no signs of forced entry or struggle, and undisturbed personal valuables, are consistent with an unattended death related to alcohol consumption.

No evidence was found to suggest homicide, suicide, or other criminal activity. The case is referred to the Medical Examiner's office for determination of cause and manner of death. No criminal investigation is ongoing. This case is closed pending Medical Examiner findings. Should autopsy or toxicology results reveal information suggesting criminal activity, this case will be reopened and further investigated accordingly.

Officer Marco Martinez, Badge #2847

Reviewed and Approved:

Sergeant Robert Williams, Badge #1203

Date: November 16, 2024